

Literature • Realistic

Grade	1	Word Count	195
Lexile	450L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A-Z	level G		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

Carlos is new at school. So, when he is asked to join the baseball team, he's excited about this chance to make new friends. But when Becky invites Carlos to her birthday party, the timing conflicts with an important baseball game. Carlos has a decision to make. Where will he go? This book is part of the Carlos series.



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Carlos Joins the Team

Written by Lorena F. Di Bello

Illustrated by Angela Kamstra-Jacobson



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Focus Question
What problem does
Carlos have in this story?
How is it fixed?





Carlos likes to play baseball.
He plays catch with his little
sister, Selena.



The baseball coach asks
Carlos to join his team.
“I’m so new in this school.
I don’t know the kids here,”
says Carlos.



“Playing sports can help
you make new friends,”
says the coach.
“Then I will join the team!”
says Carlos.



Carlos wears his baseball
glove to bed the night before
his first game.
The glove is still on his hand
when he wakes up.



At school, a girl named Becky gives Carlos a card. The card asks him to come to her birthday party.



“Oh, no!” Carlos says.
“We have a big game that day. Maybe I can come to your party instead.”



Carlos asks the coach
if he can miss the big game.
“If you don’t come,” the coach
says, “your team will be
missing a player.”



“I should not miss the game,”
Carlos says.
“The team will need me.”



On the day of the big game
all of the families come
to watch.



Carlos helps the team win.
Becky brings cake for the team!
Everybody wins!